
Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey — 65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

PROJECT CODE

SO-2024

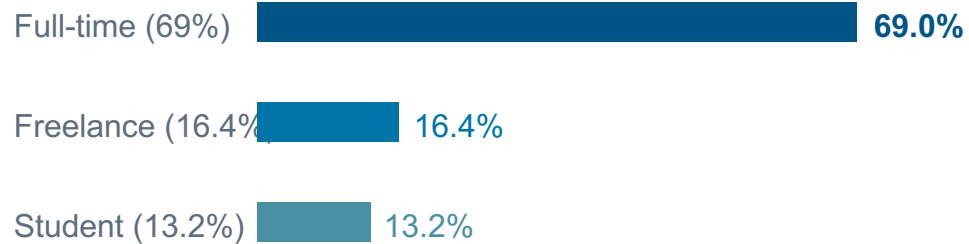
DATE

April 20, 2026

CONFIDENTIAL

KEY INSIGHT While 84% are working globally, U.S. full-time employment fell 4 percentage points year-over-year, signaling a shift.

Global Employment Status



U.S. Full-Time Employment Drop



Regional Variations

In the U.K. and Ukraine, non-full-time respondents lean toward independent contracting.

In Germany and India, they are more likely to be full-time students.

2 In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Work Environment Shifts

KEY INSIGHT While hybrid work dominates, in-person work has grown consistently over three years.

In-Person Rebound

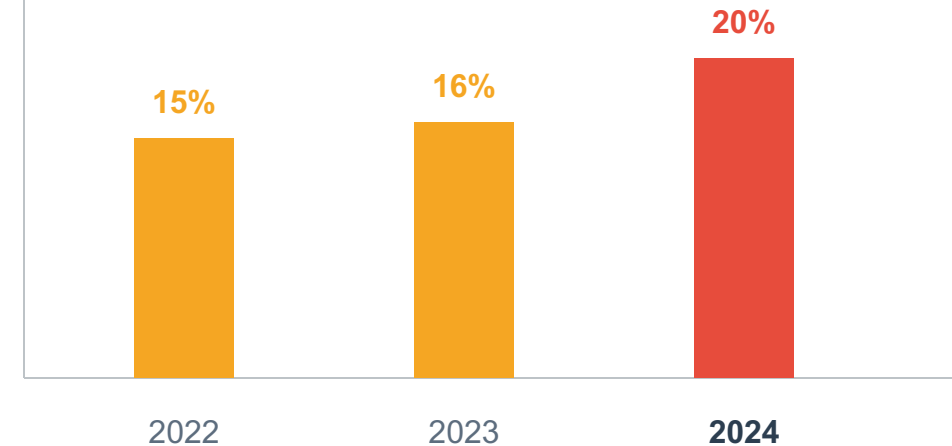
20% Up from 15% in 2022,
a gradual RTO trend.

Dominant Models

Hybrid (42%): Remains the most
common arrangement, consistent with 2023.

Remote (38%): Still accounts for
more than a third of the workforce.

Work Environment Trend (2022-2024)



3 Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Compensation by Role

KEY INSIGHT DevRel and leadership roles command premium pay, heavily correlated with 15+ years of experience.

Highest Earning Roles

Senior Executives

Median: \$127,388

Experience: ~17 yrs

Dev Advocates

Median: \$124,203

Experience: ~16 yrs

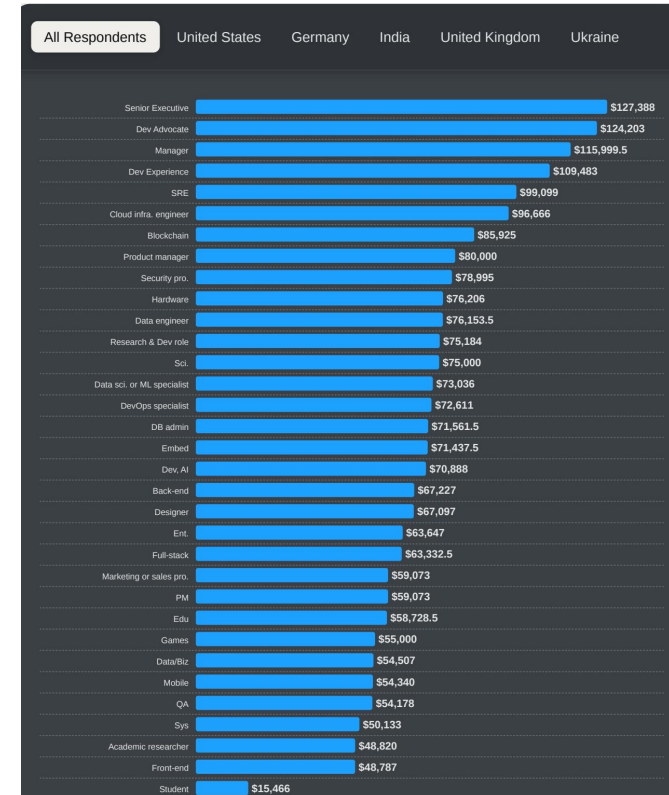
Managers

Median: \$115,999

Experience: ~15 yrs

Technical Premium:

SRE (\$99K) & Cloud Infra (\$97K)



KEY INSIGHT The clear linear relationship between years of experience and compensation continues across all technical roles.

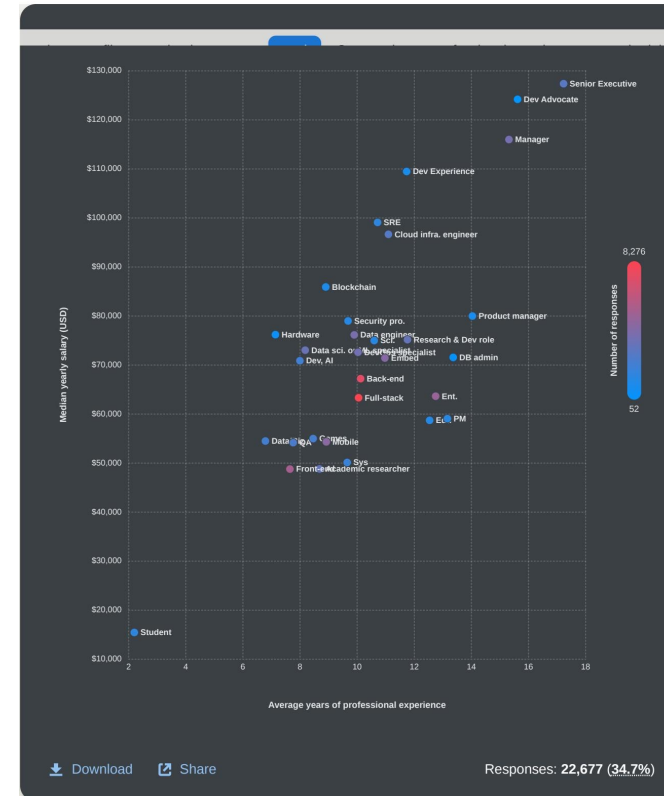
Experience Pays Off

The Senior Cluster

Roles requiring 14+ years of experience strongly correlate with six-figure median salaries.

The Entry Level

Students act as a major outlier with only ~2 years experience and \$15K median pay.



KEY INSIGHT Developers using niche functional languages earn the most, though average overall salaries dropped ~\$10K from 2023.

</> Niche Language Premium

Top Earners: Functional

Erlang: ~\$97,000

Clojure: ~\$95,000

Elixir: ~\$93,000

Lowest Earners: Mainstream & Legacy

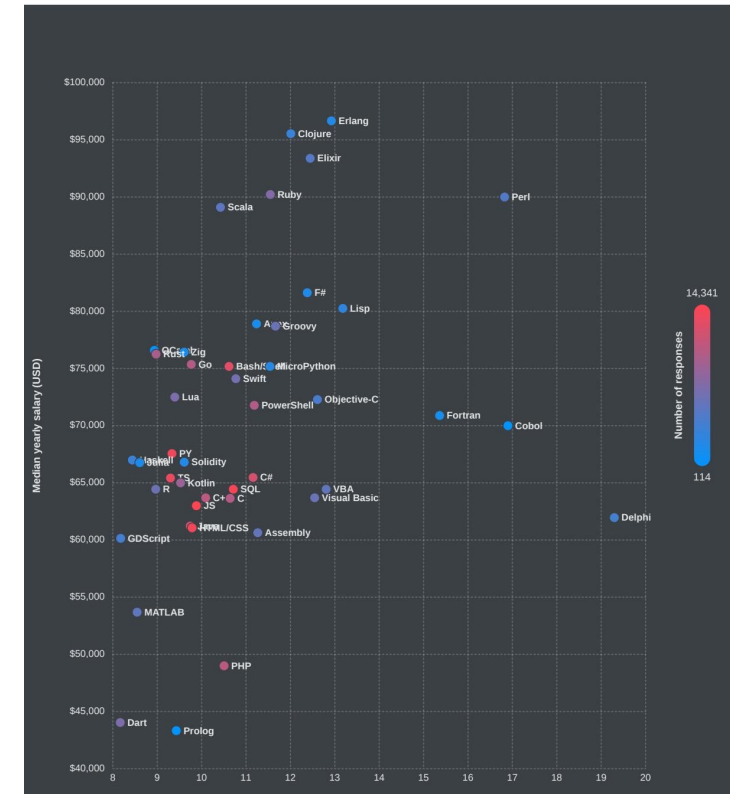
PHP: ~\$49,000

Dart: ~\$44,000

Prolog: ~\$43,000

Market Shift

Overall reported salary range dropped roughly \$10K compared to 2023 (\$60-75K vs \$70-85K).



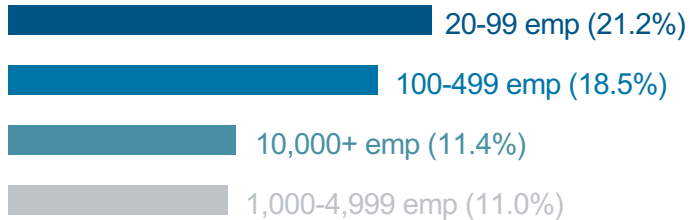
KEY INSIGHT Most developers hold purchasing power and prefer hands-on evaluation over purely building or buying.

Company Size Distribution

47%

Work at organizations < 100 employees

Top Segments:



Purchasing Influence

62%

Have influence over technology purchases

Evaluation Methods & Approach

- **Build-and-Buy:** 60% prefer a hybrid approach.
- **Free Trials:** 75% evaluate via starting free trials.
- **Word of Mouth:** 73% evaluate by asking other devs.

 **KEY INSIGHT** Adapt hiring strategies to a softening full-time market, steady hybrid work, and shifting compensation premiums.

What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

- 1 Softening Full-Time Employment:** Plan for more contractors and freelancers.
- 2 In-Person Mandates Growing:** RTO is rising, but hybrid remains the dominant mode (42%).
- 3 Premium Roles & Languages:** DevRel, SRE, and niche functional language skills command top pay.
- 4 Developer Purchasing Power:** 62% have a say in buying. Vendor strategies must target individual contributors.